

IT IS TIME TO LET GOD REIGN

Psalm 93:1 (KJV) *“The Lord reigns, He is clothed with majesty; The Lord is clothed, He has girded Himself with strength. Surely the world is established, so that it cannot be moved.”* Psalm 96:1-10 (KJV) *“Say among the nations, “The Lord reigns; The world also is firmly established, It shall not be moved; He shall judge the peoples righteously.”* Psalm 97:1 (KJV) *“The Lord reigns; Let the earth rejoice; Let the multitude of isles be glad!”* Psalm 99:1 (KJV) *“Praise to the Lord for His Holiness. The Lord reigns; Let the peoples tremble! He dwells between the cherubim; Let the earth be moved!”*

INTRO: The life of Christ followers is supposed to be a theocracy (God Rule), with Christ sitting on the throne of our lives. Tragically many have made Jesus the savior but never made Him Lord. Worse yet, so many of us allow Him to sit upon the throne of our lives,

but only until we disagree with the direction, He is taking us. Or, until a difficulty presents itself. Then, we unseat God and take the reins of our destinies into our own hands. We throw our lives into spiritual whiplash with the back and forth between self-control and God-guidance.

WHO IS IN CONTROL?

Four times in seven chapters the Psalmist declares, “*The Lord Reigns.*” This is called a sacred echo. When we hear sacred echo’s, we should set our face to seek His direction.

Let’s be honest! We sometimes wonder whether God is really in control, don’t we? Maybe something has gone wrong with our health, our relationships, our careers, or some other situation in our lives, and we are left to wonder, “*Does God even know this is happening to us right now?*” Have we ever encountered these questions? Be honest!!!

We look at what all is happening in the world, and we wonder does the Lord really reign in all this chaos?

WHAT IS GOING ON?

There is oftentimes a big difference in what is happening and what is actually going on! Paul said, “*We currently see through a glass darkly.*” This is clearly illustrated by the following stories of the Bible:

- 1) Moses spent forty years as a fugitive on the back side of the desert! That’s what was happening! What was going on, was the preparation of a leader for God’s people! That is what was really going on! “*The Lord reigns!*”
- 2) Joseph’s brothers sold him into slavery - that’s what was happening! But through that act of deceit, God was saving Joseph’s entire family, including his brothers. He was also raising up a most favored nation, called the Children of Israel! That’s what was really going on! “*The Lord reigns!*”

- 3) The Roman government exiled John to Patmos, that's what was happening! But the Book of Revelation was written while he was there. That's what was going on! ***"The Lord reigns!"***
- 4) We think of Jesus being crucified from the Easter Sunday side of the story, but to those that were there on that awful day, they had no idea how glorious Sunday would be for everyone. How can anyone say, ***"The Lord reigns,"*** when the King had just been nailed to a cross? What happened was the horrific beating and death of Jesus! What was going on was the salvation of all who would accept Jesus as their Savior! ***"The Lord reigns."***

WHAT WILL BE THE FINAL OUTCOME?

It's no different with you and me. What is happening in our lives right now may be directly opposite to what's really going on. The one thing that is for certain is, ***"The Lord reigns."***

We have a Father who is not only in control of the entire universe — He is in charge of our own personal history and destiny. Ephesians 3:10 actually describes what’s going on for us, in an earth-shaking, mind-blowing, history-making way! Check this out... ***“His intent was that now, through the church, the manifold wisdom of God should be made known to the rulers and authorities in the heavenly realms.”***

Think of this! The Apostle Paul is saying that God has put us up on the stage of history, and has put the angelic powers of heaven in graduate school, so they can learn from us, about His wisdom and glory?

This verse is telling us that what happens to us on earth has a purpose that goes far beyond us personally. What’s happening may look like:

- A divorce...
- A business failure...
- A broken relationship...
- A health crisis...

But something else is going on! When we are walking through our worst hardship, God is putting us on display!! God intends to use the events of our lives:

- The good and the bad...
- The happy and the sad...
- The positive and the negative...
- All of it...

... to make men and angels aware – “*The Lord reigns!*”

What is the final purpose? He is attempting to get us to a place where He can put us on display! When God allows difficulty in the life of the child of God, he is saying, “*Watch this!*”

He has already measured our faith and endurance and deemed us battle ready!

When life makes no sense whatsoever, we need to stop and say to ourselves, “*Something big is happening here, God is placing us on display.*”

We are giving lessons to an earthly and heavenly audience.

CONCLUSION:

Remember the sacred echo? “*The Lord Reigns!*” I encourage us today to:

- Let Him reign in good times and bad times...
- Let Him reign in success and failure...
- Let Him reign on healthy days and sick days...
- Let Him reign in prosperity and poverty...
- Let Him reign in agreement and disagreement...
- Let Him reign in wholeness and brokenness...
- Let Him reign in righteousness and sinfulness...

The message Bible says it like this: “*God rules: that’s something to shout over!*”